

DineEase Restaurant Policy & Customer Guide

This document describes the reservation, ordering, payment, cancellation, refund, and food-addition policies used by the DineEase restaurant system. The values below reflect the current configured business rules.

1. Reservation Policy

Customers can reserve a restaurant table through DineEase by selecting an available table, reservation date, start time, end time, and number of guests. The requested number of guests cannot exceed the table's seating capacity.

A table cannot have overlapping active reservations for the same date and time. A newly created reservation initially enters PENDING_PAYMENT status and becomes CONFIRMED only after successful payment verification.

2. Reservation Charges

The first hour of a reservation is free. For a reservation lasting more than one hour, the additional time is charged at **■20 per hour per guest**.

Example: A 4-guest reservation lasting 3 hours has 2 chargeable hours. The reservation charge is $2 \times 4 \times \text{■}20 = \text{■}160$.

3. Food Bill Threshold and Reservation Fee Waiver

If the food bill reaches **■1,000** or more, the reservation charge is completely waived. The customer pays only the applicable food amount.

Example: If a reservation would have a **■160** reservation charge but the food bill is **■1,200**, the reservation charge becomes **■0**.

4. Food Ordering and Addition Policy

Customers can add food items up to 30 minutes before the reservation start time. After the food-addition cutoff, additional food items cannot be added to that reservation.

Menu prices and availability are controlled by the restaurant. Customers should rely on the currently displayed DineEase menu for the latest prices and availability.

5. Payment Policy

Payments for DineEase reservations and orders are processed through Razorpay. A reservation remains pending until payment is successfully verified.

A failed, incomplete, or unverified payment does not confirm a reservation. Pending reservations have a 15-minute payment window. If payment is not completed within this period, the reservation expires and the customer must create a new reservation.

6. Cancellation Policy

Customers can cancel only confirmed reservations. A cancellation must be requested at least **1 hour before** the reservation's scheduled start time. Cancellation requests made after the 1-hour cancellation window are rejected.

Example: If a reservation begins at 8:00 PM, cancellation must be requested by 7:00 PM to remain within the current cancellation window.

7. Refund Policy

Eligible cancellations receive a refund equal to 80% of the paid amount. The remaining 20% is retained according to the current cancellation and refund policy.

Example: If the paid amount is ₹2,000 and the cancellation is eligible, the refund is $80\% \times ₹2,000 = ₹1,600$.

Refunds are initiated through Razorpay using the payment associated with the order. The final time taken for the amount to appear may depend on the payment gateway and banking system.

8. Order Policy

Orders are associated with the customer's reservation. Customers can view their own orders and order status through DineEase. Customers cannot access another customer's order or payment information.

9. Menu and Dish Information

DineEase provides menu information such as dish name, category, description, price, preparation time, calories, spice level, vegetarian status, availability, and rating where applicable. The AI assistant may provide additional dish explanations from the restaurant's menu knowledge document.

10. AI Assistant Guidelines

The DineEase AI assistant helps customers understand menu items, restaurant policies, reservations, orders, and other DineEase information. It should not invent menu ingredients, policy rules, prices, availability, order status, or refund amounts. When information cannot be verified, it should clearly say so.

11. Current Policy Constants

Policy	Current value
Refund percentage	80%
Cancellation window	1 hour before reservation start
Reservation charge	₹20 per hour per guest after the first hour
Food bill threshold	₹1,000
Food addition cutoff	30 minutes before reservation start
Pending payment expiry	15 minutes

12. Policy Updates

These values represent the current DineEase configuration. If an administrator changes business constants, this document should also be updated and the chatbot knowledge base should be re-indexed so AI responses remain consistent.